

Seventh Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Septima Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: true teaching, sanctifying fruit, and sacramental medicine

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Omnes gentes, plaudite manibus</i> (Ps. 46:2)	Universal kingship and praise	The universal King gathers praise before the Gospel warns that religious appearance can counterfeit truth.
Collect	<i>Deus, cuius providentia:</i> remove harms; grant what profits	Providence and purification	Discernment begins by asking God's unfailing providence to remove and supply what the soul cannot master alone.
Epistle	Rom. 6:19–23	Slavery, sanctification, eternal life	Freedom from sin becomes service to God whose present fruit is holiness and whose end is life.
Gradual	<i>Venite, filii, audite me;</i> <i>Accedite ad eum, et illuminamini</i> (Ps. 33:12, 6)	True teaching and illumination	The assembly approaches the Lord to receive his teaching and light, the Mass's positive answer to false prophecy.
Alleluia	<i>Omnes gentes, plaudite manibus</i> (Ps. 46:2)	Royal acclamation	Before the warning, the assembly acclaims the universal King's authority over every teacher and hearer.
Gospel	Matt. 7:15–21	False prophets, trees, fruits, obedience	Moral fruit exposes a life masked by piety; doctrinal truth still requires its proper apostolic and ecclesial norm.
Offertory	<i>Sicut in holocaustis arietum</i> (Dan. 3:40)	Humble sacrifice accepted	The assembly judges no one from above: it first asks that its own offering please God.
Secret	<i>Deus, qui legalium differentiam hostiarum unius sacrificii perfectione sanxisti ... sicut munera Abel ... cunctis proficiat</i>	Many figures, one sacrifice, common fruit	God has hallowed the diversity of legal victims through one sacrifice's perfection; he is asked to bless these gifts as Abel's and make each offering profit all unto salvation.
Communion	<i>Inclina aurem tuam, accelera, ut eripias me</i> (Ps. 30:3)	Urgent deliverance	Communicants remain petitioners who need deliverance, not spectators who have passed the test.
Postcommunion	<i>Tua nos, Domine, medicinalis operatio</i>	Healing operation	Sacramental medicine frees from perversity and leads the will toward what is right.

Sense	Synthesis
Literal	Romans 6 contrasts slavery to sin, shame, and death with service to God, sanctification, and eternal life; Matthew 7 commands vigilance toward false prophets and identifies obedience to the Father's will as decisive fruit.
Allegorical	Christ is the true teacher and obedient Son; the Church bears holy fruit only by his gift. The Gradual's teacher and the Secret's one perfect sacrifice disclose positively what false prophecy and corrupt sacrifice counterfeit.
Moral	Test a life by works rather than costume or slogans, submit one's own conduct to the same judgment, and remember that moral fruit does not by itself establish the truth of doctrine.
Anagogical	The tree's fire and Paul's opposed ends, death and eternal life, reveal final judgment; medicinal grace is offered now so that the sinner may be changed and bear fruit for life.

Voice, Fruit, Sacrifice, and Cure

This Sunday is organized by *congruence*: confession must agree with action, teaching with life, visible sacrifice with the offered heart, and the human will with the Father's will. Yet the formulary does not leave the worshipper outside the warning as an examiner of others. It moves from acclaim and hearing, through the presentation of one's members and the testing of fruit, to self-offering and sacramental cure.

St. Augustine — *Exposition on Psalm 46, 2–3, 8*

Augustine's reading of the exact chant verse is compact and governing: "Agree together must the hands and tongue. Let this confess, these work." He then places every nation beneath the King who purchased the world by his blood. Later he describes the soul serving God and ordering its members beneath it; this suggests a patristically grounded resonance with Paul's presentation of the members in Romans 6. Their relation across this formulary remains an editorial liturgical synthesis.

The Gospel: Appearance, Fruit, and Two Tests

Matthew 7:15–21 follows the narrow gate and leads into the contrast between saying "Lord, Lord" and doing the Father's will. Its images move inward and forward: clothing is immediately visible, the tree's condition is hidden, fruit becomes manifest through action, and fire belongs to God's final judgment. The Fathers preserve vigilance without pretending that every case can be reduced to one test or that a present condition is an immutable nature.

Witness	Reading of the warning	What may be tested	Necessary limit
St. John Chrysostom	<i>Homilies 23–24 on Matthew</i> chiefly expose corrupt life masked by virtue; correct confession, prophecy, and mighty works do not prove the worker holy.	The difficult way eventually discloses whether one desires virtue or only its appearance.	While remaining evil a tree cannot bear good fruit, but the person can be changed and become good.
St. Augustine	<i>On the Sermon on the Mount</i> II.24–25 includes deceptive claimants to Christian wisdom and heretics. Sheep's fleece may be genuine virtue or simulated costume.	Manifest words and deeds, especially under pressures of hoped-for gain or feared loss, disclose the governing love.	Another's heart and final guilt are not directly visible. True teaching from a bad teacher is still the vine's grape, not the thorn's fruit.
St. Jerome	<i>Commentary on Matthew</i> , book I, at 7:15–21 treats dress and speech contradicted by deeds, and poisoned teaching concealed beneath ascetic appearance.	Doctrine and life reciprocally test a teacher: an attractive life cannot make novelty revealed, while evil works contradict true words in practice.	Good and bad trees are not fixed species of human beings; conversion remains possible.

Why doctrine and life remain distinct tests

The *Didache* 11 tests both a prophet's teaching and his way of life; St. Irenaeus, *Against Heresies* III.3, locates doctrinal truth in the public apostolic preaching handed down through the Churches rather than in a claimant's prestige. Personal holiness therefore affects credibility but does not create revelation. Conversely, saying something true does not make a corrupt life true. Christian judgment concerns manifest teaching and persistent fruit; it need not claim possession of the hidden heart or the final verdict.

Romans 6: Fruit Under a New Master

Paul does not oppose bondage to morally empty independence. He contrasts two masters, two formations, two fruits, and two ends. The same person truly presents his members, yet liberation and eternal life remain gifts rather than achievements of an autonomous will.

Paul's hinge	Force in Romans 6	Patristic precision
<i>Exhibuistis / exhibete</i>	The members once deliberately presented to uncleanness are now presented to justice.	St. John Chrysostom, <i>Homily 12 on Romans</i> , notes that Paul's "human" comparison asks at least equal earnestness in serving the immeasurably better Master.
<i>Liberati / servi</i>	Freedom from sin immediately becomes service to God; there is no morally neutral, masterless state.	St. Augustine, <i>Tractate 41 on John</i> , describes Christ freeing the slave of disordered desire to become a servant of charity. Freedom is healed allegiance.
<i>Fructum / finis</i>	Sanctification is present fruit; eternal life is the end still held in hope. Sin likewise bears shameful fruit tending toward death.	Chrysostom keeps present transformation and final consummation distinct, so one impressive outcome cannot substitute for a life's trajectory.
<i>Stipendia / gratia</i>	Death is sin's wage, but eternal life is God's gift in Christ; Paul refuses a symmetrical "wage of righteousness."	Augustine, <i>On Grace and Free Will</i> 18–21, says the works rewarded are themselves formed by grace. The Christian truly wills and acts, while root and crown remain gift.

This is neither Pelagian fruit nor inert grace. Holy action is genuinely the Christian's action, but its new delight, perseverance, and supernatural end arise from God's healing gift. The Gospel's demand for fruit and Paul's proclamation of grace therefore interpret rather than cancel one another.

From the Furnace to the One Sacrifice

The Offertory takes Daniel 3:40 from Azariah's prayer in the furnace. A people without the appointed victims or place of offering asks to be received with contrite soul and humble spirit, to follow God wholeheartedly, and not to be confounded because it trusts him. The Secret places Azariah's desire for accepted sacrifice within the accomplished perfection of the one sacrifice.

Latin hinge in the Secret	Movement	Theological precision
<i>sanxisti ... legalium differentiam hostiarum ... unius sacrificii perfectione</i>	The perfect tense first confesses God's accomplished act: by the perfection of the one sacrifice, he has hallowed and definitively ordered the diversity of legal victims.	Their diversity remains as figural witness but receives its unity and completion in Christ, not in rival sacrifices beside him.
<i>accipe ... a devotis tibi famulis</i>	God is asked to receive the sacrifice from devoted servants.	Liturgical action is not self-validating performance; devotion, obedience, and divine acceptance belong together.
<i>sicut munera Abel, sanctifica</i>	Abel's accepted gifts are invoked while God himself is asked to sanctify what is now offered.	St. Irenaeus, <i>Against Heresies</i> IV.18, joins Abel's acceptance to righteousness and communion with the neighbor, refusing a merely external sacrifice.

Latin hinge in the Secret	Movement	Theological precision
<i>quod singuli obtulerunt ... cunctis proficiat ad salutem</i>	What individuals offered is asked to benefit everyone unto salvation.	Personal oblation is ordered beyond private possession to the common good of Christ's body.

Body and Church within the one sacrifice

St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 20 on Romans*, joins Daniel's contrite prayer to the living sacrifice of Romans 12 and names eyes, tongue, hands, feet, and hearing as offerings. St. Augustine, *City of God* X.5–6, 20, calls visible sacrifice the sign of invisible self-offering and says that the redeemed city is offered through the one High Priest. Together they illuminate—without directly commenting on this Secret—how bodily service, personal oblation, and the salvation of all can be held within Christ's one sacrifice.

Hear, Approach, and Be Healed

The Gradual is the positive counterpart to the Gospel's false voices. In his direct exposition of Psalm 33, 9 and 15, Augustine hears Christ calling the children to learn, and reads "approach him and be enlightened" as movement toward the Crucified to receive his Body and Blood. They approach by faith and longing; the feet with which they run are the twofold charity of God and neighbor. Discernment therefore begins not in suspicion but in docility and sacramental approach.

At Communion, Augustine's *Exposition on Psalm 30*, 1–4, hears "Incline thine ear; make haste to deliver me" first in the humbled Christ's voice and then in his people. The Church does not borrow a stranger's panic; Christ's body enters the Son's filial petition. Yet rescue is not the formulary's final word. The Postcommunion asks for a medicine that changes the will which must bear good fruit.

Prayer's language	Requested action	Completion of the Sunday
Collect: <i>noxia cuncta submoveas</i>	Remove every harmful thing.	Purification and divine assistance precede the act of discernment.
Postcommunion: <i>a nostris perversitatibus expediat</i>	Let the sacramental operation free or disentangle us from perverse turnings.	Romans 6's liberation reaches the inclinations that made sin's service appear free.
Collect: <i>omnia nobis profutura concedas;</i> Postcommunion: <i>ad ea quae sunt recta perducat</i>	Grant what profits and lead us through to what is right.	Gift becomes direction, enacted righteousness, sanctifying fruit, and finally eternal life.

St. Augustine — *On Man's Perfection in Righteousness* 3

Augustine's lame person remains commanded to walk rightly but cannot will away the defect: medicine must cure the foot and assist the will. Command is preserved because healing, not redefinition, makes right walking possible.

St. Ignatius — *Ephesians* 20

Ignatius calls the one bread "the medicine of immortality" and joins it to ecclesial unity and life in Christ. The phrase illuminates the oration's medicine and Paul's final gift without replacing the prayer's own active verbs.

The final reversal

Counterfeit religion is answered not by suspicion perfected but by a truthful body formed in Christ. Discernment remains profound because the discernor must consent to the same judgment, offering, and medicine, and become the congruent life he seeks.

Source boundaries

Augustine on Psalm 46, 2–3, Psalm 33, 9 and 15, and Psalm 30, 1–4, together with Chrysostom on Matthew 7 and Romans 6, provides **direct exegesis** of the appointed biblical texts. Psalm 46, 8, is **same-psalm illumination**; its relation to Romans 6 is editorial. Irenaeus, Ignatius, Augustine on sacrifice and grace, and Chrysostom on Romans 12 provide **doctrinal illumination**. The movement among the separate propers is this guide’s **editorial liturgical synthesis**; it is not attributed to any Father or offered as a claim about the formulary’s composition.

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* (1962), *Dominica Septima post Pentecosten*; local OCR temporal corpus, Introit through Postcommunion. Latin OCR remains subject to printed-missal verification.
- Holy Scripture: Romans 6:19–23; Matthew 7:15–23; Daniel 3:38–43; Psalms 46, 33, and 30 in Vulgate numbering.
- St. Augustine, *Expositions on the Psalms*: Psalm 46, 2–3, 8, working text; Psalm 33, 9 and 15, working text; Psalm 30, 1–4, working text. New Advent’s headings use Psalms 47, 34, and 31 respectively.
- St. Augustine, *On the Sermon on the Mount* II.24.78–81 and II.25.82–86, working public-domain text; St. John Chrysostom, *Homilies 23–24 on Matthew*, Homily 23 and Homily 24.
- St. Jerome, *Commentary on Matthew*, book I, at 7:15–21, PL 26:48–49. A working English extract is preserved in the later *Catena Aurea*; the summary above does not claim its wording as a direct translation of the full commentary.
- *Didache* 11, working public-domain text; St. Irenaeus, *Against Heresies* III.3, apostolic tradition, and IV.18.1–5, Abel and oblation.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 12 on Romans*, on 6:19–23, working text; *Homily 20 on Romans*, on 12:1–2 and Daniel’s prayer, working text.
- St. Augustine, *City of God* X.5–6, 20, visible sacrifice, self-offering, and the one High Priest; *Tractate 41 on John*, 3–10, slavery and freedom; *On Grace and Free Will* 18–21, works and gift; *On Man’s Perfection in Righteousness* 3, medicine and the will.
- St. Ignatius of Antioch, *Letter to the Ephesians* 20, working public-domain text.